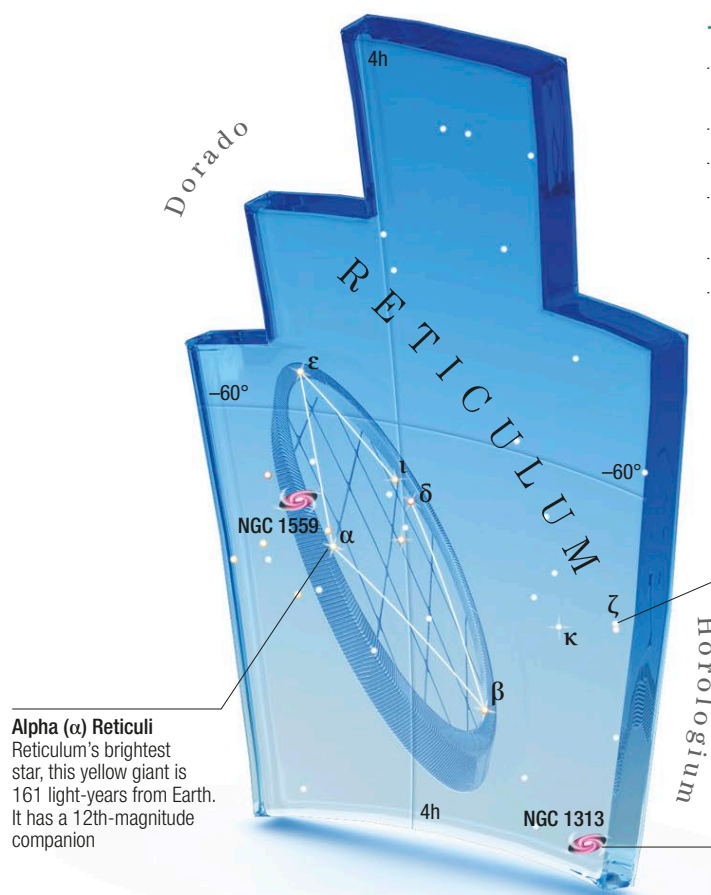


RETICULUM

THE NET

A FAINT DIAMOND SHAPE OF STARS IN THE SOUTHERN SKY, RETICULUM IS LOCATED NORTHWEST OF THE LARGE MAGELLANIC CLOUD IN DORADO.

The stars in this region were first grouped together in 1621 as the constellation Rhombus, the diamond, by German astronomer Isaac Habrecht. It was given its current description in the 1750s by French astronomer Nicolas Louise de Lacaille. The name refers to the reticule, the gridlike crosshairs in a telescope's eyepiece used to measure the positions of the stars. One of the smallest constellations, its principal attractions are the double star Zeta Reticuli and some faint galaxies, including NGC 1313, a starburst galaxy where unusually large numbers of hot young stars are forming, and NGC 1559, a spiral galaxy 50 million light-years away.



Alpha (α) Reticuli
Reticulum's brightest star, this yellow giant is 161 light-years from Earth. It has a 12th-magnitude companion

KEY DATA

Size ranking	82
Brightest stars	Alpha (α) 3.4 Beta (β) 3.8
Genitive	Reticuli
Abbreviation	Ret
Highest in sky at 10pm	December
Fully visible	23°N–90°S



CHART 2

Zeta (ζ) Reticuli
Visible to the naked eye, this double star is 39 light-years away; binoculars reveal a pair of yellow stars of magnitudes 5.2 and 5.9

NGC 1313
About one-third the width of the Milky Way, this barred spiral galaxy is about 15 million light-years away

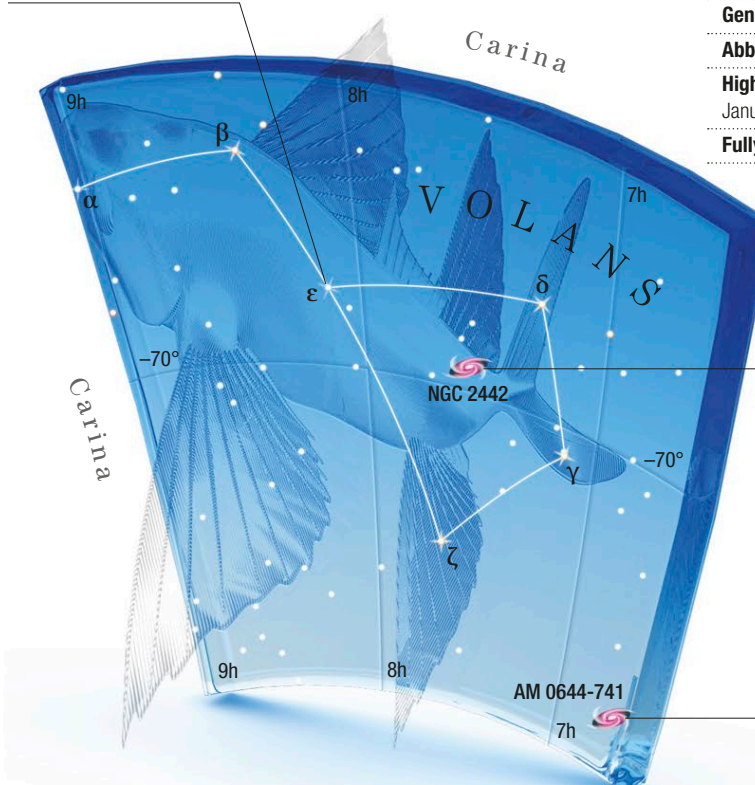
VOLANS

THE FLYING FISH

THIS INDISTINCT CONSTELLATION IS SITUATED BETWEEN THE BRIGHT STARS OF CARINA AND THE SOUTH CELESTIAL POLE.

Volans was described by the Dutch explorers Peter Dirkszoon Keyser and Frederick de Houtman in the 1590s. Its most interesting features are its double stars, such as Gamma Volantis, visible with a small telescope, and its galaxies, which can be seen only with large telescopes. Like a huge letter "S", NGC 2442 has an arm coming from each end of a bar. Nicknamed the "Meathook," its distorted shape is the result of a near-miss with a smaller galaxy. Formerly a spiral, AM 0644-741 is a now a ring galaxy as a result of a collision with another galaxy.

Epsilon (ε) Volantis
A blue-white subgiant of magnitude 4.4. A companion of magnitude 8.1 can be seen with a small telescope



KEY DATA

Size ranking	76
Brightest stars	Beta (β) 3.8, Gamma (α) 3.8
Genitive	Volantis
Abbreviation	Vol
Highest in sky at 10pm	January–March
Fully visible	14°N–90°S



CHART 2

NGC 2442
A face-on barred spiral galaxy, 50 million light-years away, and visible only with a large telescope; it is 75,000 light-years wide

AM 0644-741
A ring galaxy 150,000 light-years across that resembles a diamond- and sapphire-encrusted bracelet, wrapped around a yellow nucleus